14.5 Cardiac Arrest and Post-Resuscitation Care*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Return of spontaneous circulation after cardiac arrest • BP 88/50 mmHg • Intubated; GCS 6	**ACTUAL** Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion related to post-arrest myocardial dysfunction as evidenced by hypotension.	• MAP of 65 mmHg or more.	• Keep ECG, BP and SpO_2 on continuous monitoring. • Give vasopressors as prescribed. • Record a 12-lead ECG and prepare for coronary angiography if ordered. • Keep SpO_2 on target, avoiding both too little and too much oxygen.	• Considered met when MAP is on target.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • GCS 6; ventilator-dependent • Possible seizure activity	**ACTUAL** Impaired spontaneous ventilation related to hypoxic–ischemic brain injury as evidenced by GCS 6 and dependence on mechanical ventilation.	• Ventilation maintained and no secondary brain injury.	• Control temperature per protocol and prevent fever. • Keep glucose and CO_2 within normal limits. • Watch for seizures. • Keep the head of the bed at 30 degrees.	• Goal reached while neurological status is stable.
Subjective • Family ask, “Will he wake up?” **Objective** • Outcome uncertain	**RISK** Risk for maladaptive grieving [family] as evidenced by risk factors: sudden critical illness of a family member and uncertain prognosis.	• Family receive information and support.	• Give regular, honest updates. • Make it easy for the family to be present. • Offer spiritual and social support.	• Met when the family feel supported.

*References for this care plan: [35], [109], [124], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.